

• PERSONALISED ROADMAP • STAGE 1 • UNDER \$1M

The Manufacturer's PROFIT ROADMAP

You are the factory. This is your plan to get the business off your back without everything falling apart.

By **Bernard Powell**
Premier Business Academy · Hamilton, NZ



STAGE 1 DIAGNOSIS

**Where You Are The Honest Truth
You're turning over under \$1M. And
you ARE the factory. Every quote,
every quality check, every customer
call, every late night fixing something
that broke - that's all you. Revenue
might be climbing, but the bank
account tells a different story.**

WHAT THIS FEELS LIKE

You wake up already behind. Before your feet hit the floor, your brain is running through the list - the quote you forgot to send, the machine that needs fixing, the customer who called twice yesterday. You get to the factory early and leave late. Dinner is cold. Your partner asks how your day was and you don't even know where to start. Weekends blur into weekdays. You can't remember the last time you did something that wasn't work.

12 MONTHS FROM NOW

If nothing changes, you'll have another year of record revenue and record exhaustion - still doing every job yourself, only more tired, more stretched, and further from the business you actually wanted to build.

97% of NZ businesses have fewer than 20 staff. Most are stuck right here - busy, growing on paper, and running on the owner's back.

"The good news: every Stage 3 manufacturer started where you are. The difference is what they did next."

— Bernard Powell

What you'll read next Production - SOPs and quality systems. Sales & Pricing - cost-per-unit and quote discipline. Cash Flow - Friday rhythm and forecasting. People - delegation and retention. Systems - documented process ownership. Marketing - referrals and lead consistency. Your Role - shifting from worker to owner.

AREA 1 OF 7

Production No SOPs. Quality depends on you. Every job needs your eyes.

Nothing is written down. Anyone who helps you can't do a job without checking with you first because the process lives in your head. If you take a sick day, things go wrong - and you pay for it Monday.

\$85,800/yr The math: 30 hrs/wk of owner time spent on work a \$25/hr person could do = roughly \$85,800/yr in wasted capacity. Even a part-time hire closes a lot of that gap.

The Fix - Do This Week:

1. Pick your top 5 recurring tasks. Write a one-page "how I do it" for each.
2. Time yourself doing each task. Film one on your phone.
3. Hand the written process and video to whoever helps you - or to the first person you hire.
4. Check daily for week 1, every other day for week 2. Then let go.

"I spent 2 years doing every job at Premier Group. The day I wrote my first process document was the day the business started growing."

— Bernard Powell

Bernard's note The first SOP should be ugly. A phone video, a checklist, and one clear quality standard beat another month of explaining the job from scratch. Clean it up later - the real win is getting the process out of your head.

AREA 2 OF 7

Sales & Pricing Quoting every job from gut feel. No idea of true cost per unit.

You quote from memory and gut instinct. You've never calculated the real cost of producing your top products. Electricity is up 12%, raw materials up 20–40%, wages up - but your prices are the same as two years ago. You absorb every cost increase and wonder why there's no money left.

\$75,000+/yr If your prices are just 15% too low on \$500K revenue, that's \$75,000 in lost profit every year. At \$1M revenue, it's \$150K.

The Fix:

1. Calculate true cost-per-unit for your top products. Materials + labour + overheads + waste. No guessing.
2. Add a 30% margin minimum. Raise prices on the worst offenders this month, not next quarter.
3. In 20 years of coaching, I've never seen a manufacturer lose a good customer over a fair price increase.

"Most factory owners price based on what they THINK the market will pay, not what it actually costs them to produce."

— Bernard Powell

Common trap Owners often mistake a fast yes for a good quote. The goal is not to win every job. The goal is to win the right work at the right margin, with a method someone else can repeat.

AREA 3 OF 7

Cash Flow No visibility. Money in, money out. Check your bank and hope.

Your cash flow management is opening the banking app and seeing if there's enough to cover wages. You don't forecast. You've had sleepless nights worrying about payroll. You invoice at end of month, customers pay at 60+ days, but suppliers and staff don't wait.

46% can't pay themselves Nearly half of NZ business owners at this stage can't draw a proper wage. You're funding your customers' businesses with your own cash flow.

The Fix - Start This Friday:

1. Every Friday, block 15 minutes. Answer: What came in? What went out? What's due next week? Do this for 4 weeks straight.
2. Invoice immediately on delivery - not end of month. Chase at 14 days, not 60. Offer 2% for 7-day payment.
3. Negotiate 60-day terms with your top 3 suppliers.

"You can't fix what you can't see. The 15-minute Friday check changed everything for me."

— Bernard Powell

At this stage Cash flow discipline is less about finance jargon and more about facing reality weekly. A simple forecast reviewed every Friday beats a sophisticated spreadsheet you avoid opening.

AREA 4 OF 7

People Can't delegate because nothing is documented.

Whether you're running solo or have a handful of helpers, you can't truly delegate. Training takes forever because you have to show everything in person. You're afraid to hire - or hire more - because you've been burned before.

330 per week 330 NZ workers leave for Australia every single week. The people you hire will leave too - unless you have systems that make them want to stay.

The Fix:

1. Hire a part-time helper - or promote someone if you already have a team. Give them the written processes from Area
2. Start with the task you hate most. Let them own it fully. Accept 80% as good as you - that's enough.
3. Run a 3-question retention audit with each team member: What would make you leave? What's most frustrating? What would make this the best job ever? Act on one answer per person within 2 weeks.

"People don't leave bad companies - they leave bad leaders. Three questions. That's all it takes to find out what your people need."

— Bernard Powell

Bernard's note Most delegation fails because the standard was never clear enough to inspect. Give people the process, the expected result, and a review point. Then coach the gap instead of taking the job back.

AREA 5 OF 7

Systems All in your head. If you got hit by a bus, it's over.

Your business has zero documented systems. If you disappeared tomorrow, nobody could run this place for even a week. Suppliers, customers, processes, passwords - all locked in one skull. That's not a business. That's a single point of failure.

\$0 sale value A business with no documented systems has zero sale value. Nobody will buy what they can't run without you.

The Fix - One Process Per Week:

1. Film yourself doing a key task. Get someone to write the steps from watching the video.
2. Review the written steps. Done - that's a documented process.
3. One process per week = 50 documented processes by next year.

"At Premier Group, we documented over 200 processes. Not because I love paperwork - because I wanted to go on holiday without my phone ringing."

— Bernard Powell

Common trap If a process cannot survive your day off, it is not yet a system. Document the trigger, the steps, and what "done right" looks like. Then test whether someone else can run it without chasing you.

AREA 6 OF 7

Marketing Word of mouth only. No system for getting new customers.

All your customers came through word of mouth. You've never run an ad, never asked for a referral systematically. Your top few customers probably make up a huge chunk of revenue. One phone call could wipe out a third of it overnight.

1 phone call away Referrals convert at 4× the rate of cold leads, but you have to actually ask. When your biggest customer leaves, you have no pipeline to replace them.

The Fix - 5 Conversations This Week:

1. Identify your 5 best customers. Call each one: "Who else do you know who needs what we make?"
2. Follow up on every name within 48 hours. Make it a monthly habit.
3. Set up a Google Business profile. Ask your best 10 customers for Google reviews this week.

"I built Premier Group without a single paid ad for the first 5 years. Referrals from happy customers. But you have to ASK."

— Bernard Powell

At this stage Referrals work best when you ask right after a win, not when things go quiet. One simple referral question used every month is stronger than a grand marketing plan nobody owns.

AREA 7 OF 7

Your Role Doing everything. You ARE the factory.

You open the factory and close it. Quote the jobs, run the machines, check quality, chase invoices, deal with every problem. If you dropped dead tomorrow, the business dies with you. That's not a business - that's a hostage situation disguised as self-employment.

Everything Your health. Your relationships. Your freedom. A business that can't run without its owner isn't a business - it's a trap.

The Fix:

1. Track your time for 1 full week. Highlight tasks that ONLY you can do.
2. Everything else is your delegation list. Pick one item - hand it off this week. Next week, hand off another.
3. Block 2 hours every Tuesday for working ON the business. Strategy only. No email.

"The hardest thing I ever did was stop being the best worker in my own factory. It was also the most profitable thing I ever did."

— Bernard Powell

Bernard's note Your highest-value work is choosing priorities, removing blockers, and making better decisions earlier. Every recurring task you keep by habit steals time from the part only the owner can do.

HOW YOU GRADUATE

Moving to \$1M–\$2M You don't need to be perfect. Just these foundations. Achievable within 90 days.

- 5+ processes documented - written down, not just in your head
- True cost-per-unit calculated for your top products
- Weekly cash flow check happening - 4 Fridays in a row
- At least 1 task fully delegated - someone else owns it
- Prices reviewed - and the worst offenders raised

None of this requires expensive consultants, software, or an MBA. It requires pen, paper, a phone camera, and the willingness to let go.

Quick check before you move on • One number you will review every week • One task someone else now owns • One process the team can run without asking you

YOUR 90 - DAY PLAN

The 10 Actions That Move You to \$1M–\$2M Specific. Measurable. Time-bound. Do these in order.

WEEK 1–2 WEEK 3–4

1. Document your top 5 recurring
1. Hire a part-time helper (or promote processes. One page each. Film one someone if you already have a team). on your phone. Give them to your best
2. Delegate one task fully. Give them person. the written process. Check weekly. Let
2. Calculate true cost-per-unit for your them own it. top products. Materials + labour +
3. Raise prices on your bottom 20% of overheads + waste. No guessing. products. This month, not next
3. Start the Friday 15-minute cash flow quarter. check. What came in, what went out, what's due. Every Friday.

MONTH 2 MONTH 3

1. Track your time for 1 full week.
1. Ask 10 customers for referrals. Highlight the tasks only you can do. Phone calls, not emails. "Who else Everything else goes on the needs what we make?" delegation list.
2. Review your 90-day progress. Hours
2. Film and document 4 more worked, profit margin, documented processes. That's 9 total. You're processes, delegation wins. building your operations manual.

90 days from now You'll have 9+ documented processes, accurate pricing, a cash flow rhythm, and your first real delegation wins. That's the jump to \$1M–\$2M.

Priority order Visibility first. Ownership second. Growth third. If you try to grow before the numbers and handoffs are real, you usually just scale the stress.

WHY BERNARD / PBA

You've Read the Roadmap. Now Don't Do It Alone.

Reading a roadmap is easy. Actually changing a factory is not. The owners who break through rarely do it alone: they borrow someone else's 30 years of pattern recognition, their own honest mirror, and their refusal to slip back into the comfort of being busy.

Bernard Powell built Premier Group NZ from scratch into a 200 tonne-per-day manufacturer, #1 NZ Best Workplace and AME Global Lean recognised. He lived every stage of your journey before coaching a single person.

500+ owners coached · 200 tonnes/day factory · #1 NZ Best Workplace · AME Global Lean · 141 five-star reviews

What actually changes when you work with Bernard

1. You stop guessing your numbers. The first session maps true cost per unit and your biggest profit leak. Fixing under-pricing alone often pays for the engagement.

2. You build the leverage you have been missing: systems, SOPs and delegated ownership. The boring work most coaches skip is what turns a factory from a trap into a business.

3. You get someone who has made the mistakes. Bernard has seen the ways NZ manufacturers break and the patterns that get them past \$5M+.

4. You do not get a generic playbook. Every session is grounded in your factory, your staff, your market and what you are dealing with this week.

Best fit: owners who want blunt feedback and fast implementation—not vague encouragement while keeping the same bottlenecks.

WHAT OWNERS SAY

Real NZ Owners. Real Results.

"Bernard is all go. Full of insights and immediate action. We have been blown away by just how quickly PBA implements and starts bringing positive change." — Adrian Day · NZ Manufacturer

"We have had great help from Bernard at PBA shifting mindset and getting stuff done that would otherwise never have happened." — Patrick Whiteman · NZ Business Owner

"Joining Premier Business Academy was one of the best things we have done in years. We joined because we wanted to improve the life our business gives us." — Joshua Prestidge · NZ Business Owner

"Bernard is the real deal business coach. Genuine, inspiring and full of energy and ideas. I am seeing a real upward trend in my sales results." — Tim Farland · NZ Business Owner

YOUR NEXT STEP

Stop guessing. Get a Growth Assessment Session. In 45 minutes, a top PBA advisor will help identify where your factory is, what is holding it back and the single most important thing to fix first.

[Book Your Free Growth Assessment →](#)

500+ NZ manufacturers coached · 141 five-star reviews · Free, no obligation